

LTXV in FT – Image to Video

UR Team Sep '25 

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What is the **purpose** of this research?

- 1) Understand users' current behaviors, pain points & needs, around creating motion based content
- 2) Explore users' use cases, pains & needs for transforming still images into ones with movement
- 3) View users' reactions and perceptions of the different image-to-video concepts created with LTXV, and whether the concepts are seen as useful or valuable

Main RQ

1

What **pains** and **needs** do users face when creating **motion-based content** for TikTok or Instagram Stories, and Reels *today*

2

In what **situations** is transforming a still photo into a moving one **most valuable**

- In their day to day lives
- Which concept do they feel would be most valuable or appealing – and why?

3

What **types of photos** are **worth** transforming into moving ones and **why**

What was done



Audience

10 users participated in-depth interviews & concept testing, divided to 2 groups:

- **Group 1** – 5 **Gen Z** users (aged between 21-26)
- **Group 2** – 5 **Millennial** users (aged between 30-35)
- All users were **FT users** who tend to **share videos** such as Reels, TikToks or Stories

What was done

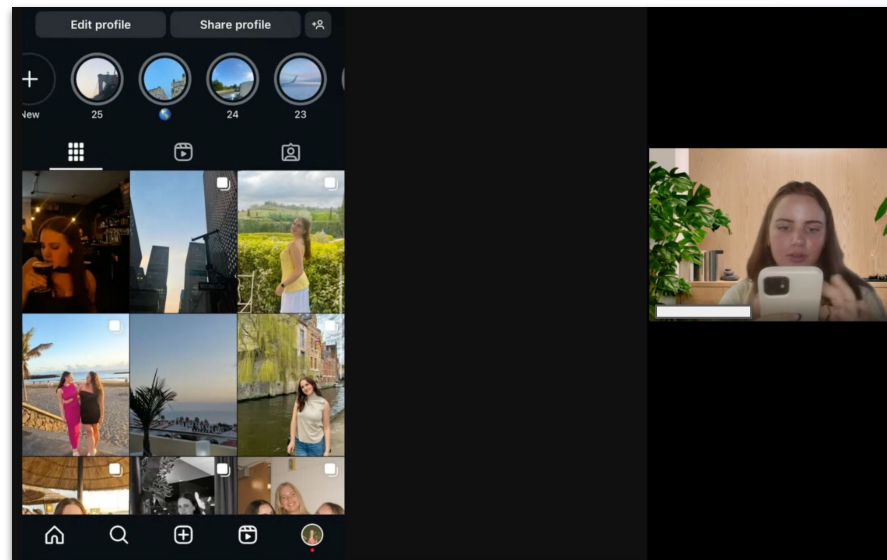
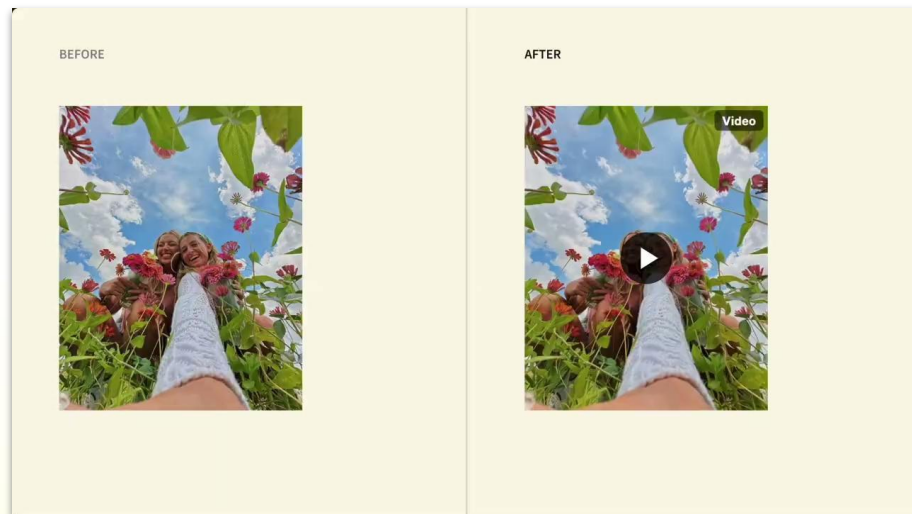


Photo vs. Video: Current behaviors & platform strategies

Photos are the **default** – but not always enough

Photos

- **Easier** to capture in **higher quality**, **edit**, and share across platforms
- Photos offer **control** – users can choose what to include, avoid unwanted details (like people or noise), and edit their appearance precisely

Videos

- Videos are typically used when the full context is needed – to show how a **moment felt** – the **atmosphere, reactions**, full scenery or **movement** that made it special

Users find capturing and editing *videos* more difficult and time-consuming. **Why?**

- 1) They struggle with achieving **good lighting, flattering angles**, and **precise cuts** on mobile devices (compared to desktop editing)
- 2) Many feel they **lack the skills** or **tools** to produce videos that meet their standards
- 3) They are **not aware** of options to improve their **appearance in videos** like they are used to in photos (e.g., retouch, hide small imperfections, etc.)

How Users Capture & Share



Instagram

Photos are preferred; the content is **curated and polished** for friends, acquaintances, and family to view



TikTok

Most users are passive on TikTok (not posting), and it's perceived as an **influencer space & branding tool** – a platform for creators who want to monetize their content

	Instagram	TikTok
Content Type & Purpose	Mostly curated photos with a few short videos to showcase life and special events	Fun, and random content without a clear goal
Effort & Editing	Users put in high effort using external editing apps for a aesthetic look, focusing on quality & lighting	Minimal editing , mostly in-app or with CapCut, with a spontaneous, casual, experimental vibe
User's followers	Viewed as more personal – shared with friends, family, and broader circles	Smaller following of close friends; personal/family content rarely shared due to uncertainty about who might see it

TikTok for aspiring influencers

Aspiring influencers invest heavily in content – vlogs, fashion, lifestyle, tips, and reviews. Videos are intentional and well-planned, designed to grow an audience and monetize

Current behaviours:

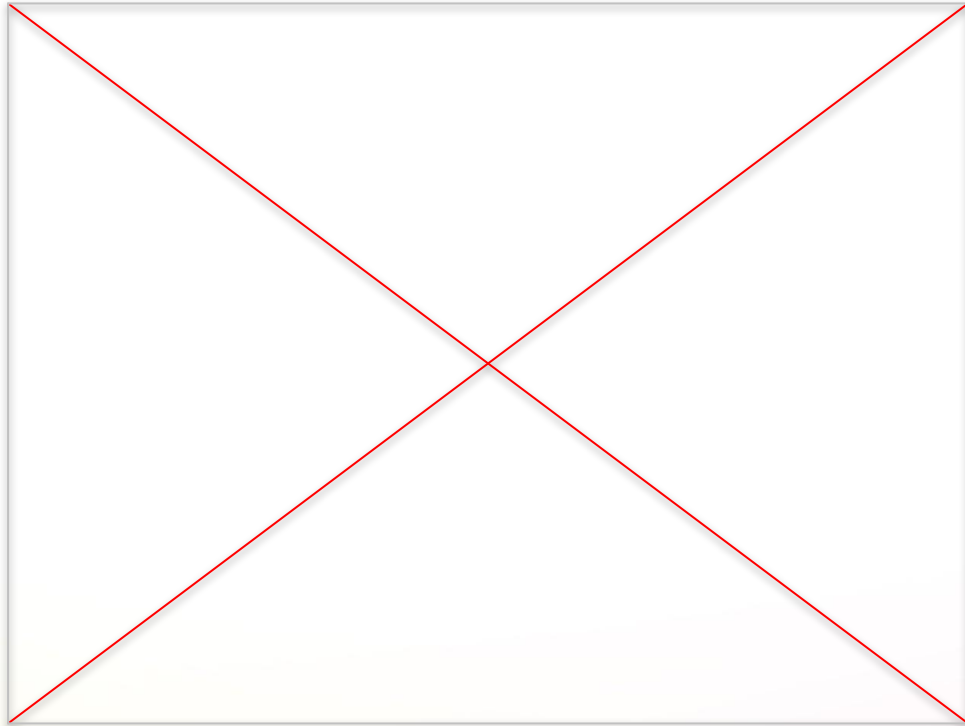
- **Invest a lot of time & effort in video editing:** often in CapCut, Splice, etc., requiring hours for precise cuts, sound, text, and professional polish
- **Cross-posted:** content created for TikTok is frequently shared on Instagram Reels to maximize reach
- **Public/professional space:** seen as content for wide or unknown audiences, not just close friends



Current behaviors on Instagram & opportunities

	Single post on feed	carousel post on feed	Stories	Reels
Type of content	Photos are preferred	Photos & videos to add variety and vibe	Photos or very short videos (10–30s)	Videos, or combined photos or live photos
Effort & Editing	High-effort editing for a curated, polished look meant to last	High-effort editing for a curated, polished look meant to last	Less scrutiny makes content more casual and simple, though some still edit for aesthetics	Creating a polished reel requires effort, but some just throw content together with little effort
Post frequency	Posting infrequently, monthly or bi-weekly	Posting infrequently, monthly or bi-weekly	Posting frequently, daily or multiple times per week	Depends on the user, but mostly after an event or a trip

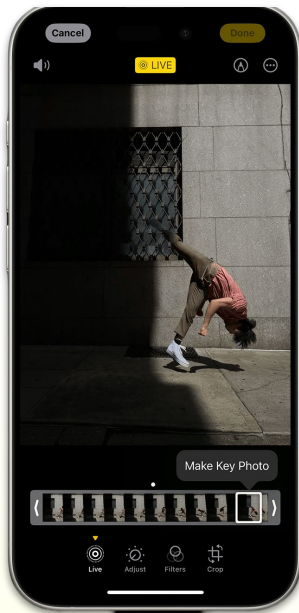
How Users Capture & Share: Instagram vs. TikTok



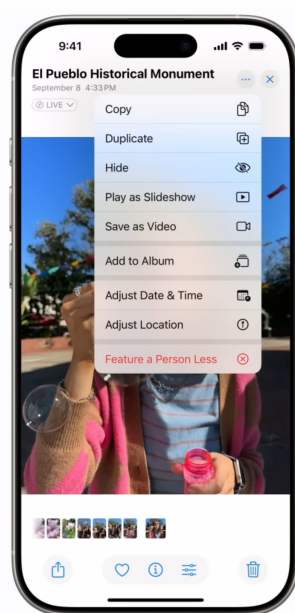
Transforming still images into ones with movement

Live Photos = Our biggest competitor when it comes to image-to-video creation

When asked about turning stills into motion, Live Photos immediately came to mind – often the only method users had ever used or even knew existed.



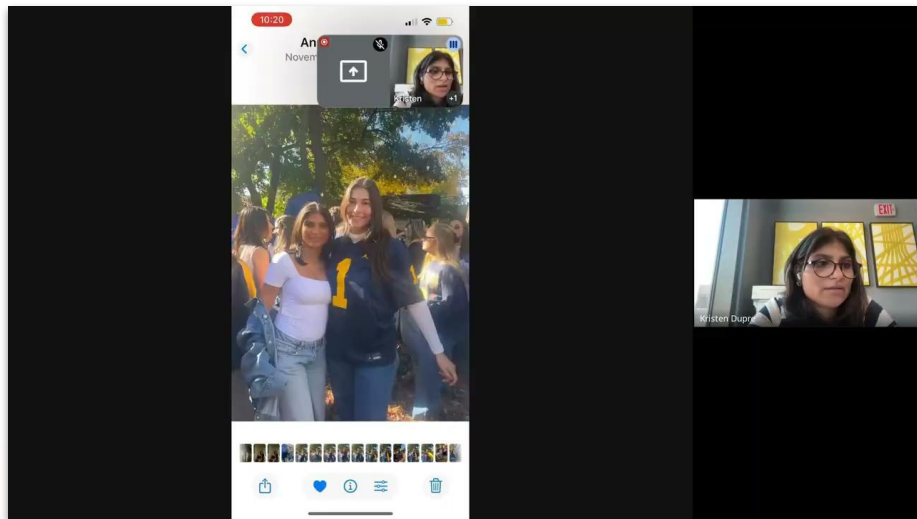
Some use them just to select a **better still frame**, not for creating or sharing motion content



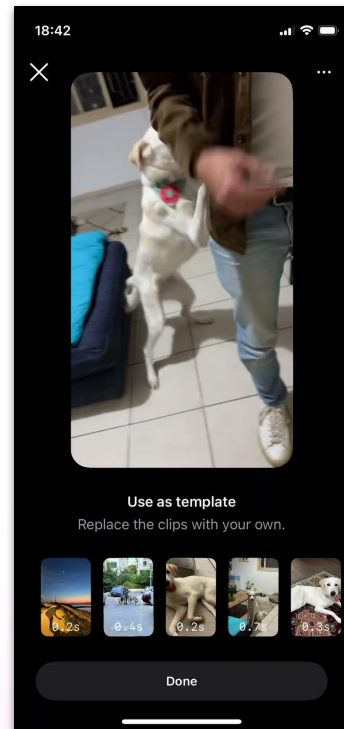
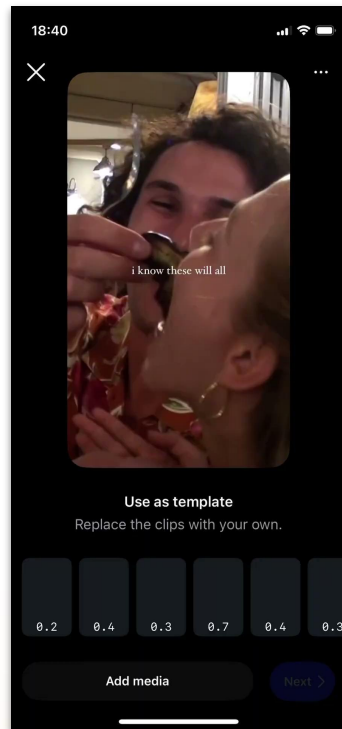
Others **extract short videos** from Live Photos or even **combine several** to make short Reels, Stories or TikToks

Live Photos = Our biggest competitor when it comes to image-to-video creation

Examples of users who
extract short videos
from Live Photos

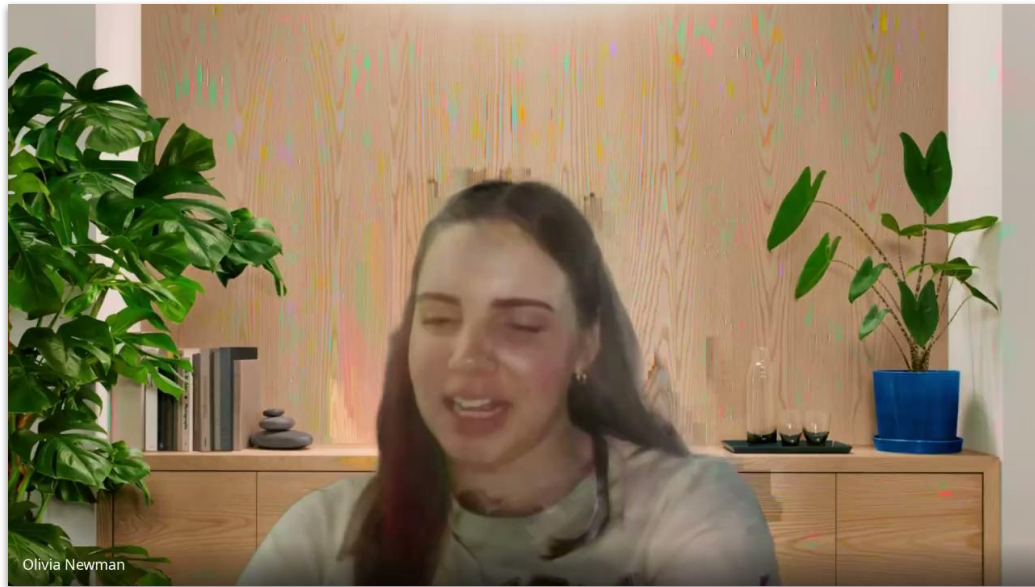


Instagram and TikTok let users combine photos & live photos into curated videos, using templates – but with limited control over each photo length



However, live photos come with **key pain points** that we can turn into **opportunities**

- Users often **forget** to turn them on, leading to **missed moments**
- The output feels **jumpy, short**, or **low quality**
- Many users **don't realize** they can be **converted into videos**



In which **moments or situations** would ***turning a photo into a video*** be especially **useful or meaningful** for users?

Motive #1: Core emotional driver: regret over 'missed moments'

Users consistently wished they'd captured videos instead of only photos in personal, sentimental moments – especially with loved ones or during special trips and events.

Common examples:

- **Captured in Motion** → a child being thrown in the air, friends dancing together, or the in-between moments while a group poses for a photo
- **Sentimental moments with loved ones** → family hugs at milestone events, couple's special moments at their wedding
- **Capturing the feel of a place** → Users often regret not capturing the full 'vibe' of a place they visited – the streets, people, food, sounds, scenery, and the unique atmosphere of the city or country

Adding motion helps recreate the feeling of being there. Users want to re-experience not just what something looked like, but also how it felt and sounded

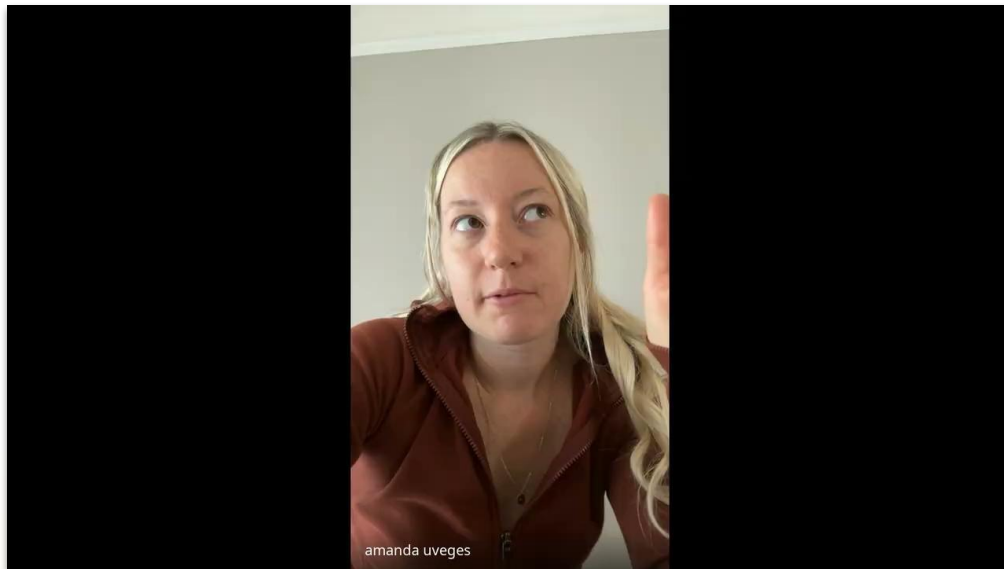
What element enable people to relive a moment?

- Atmosphere
- Sounds
- People walking in the Streets
- Personal Interactions
- Ambient details of a location

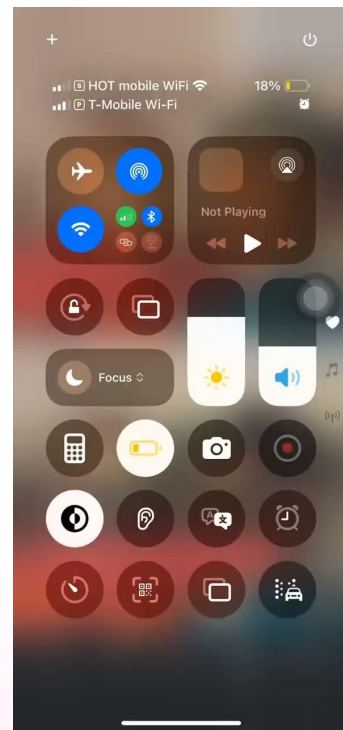
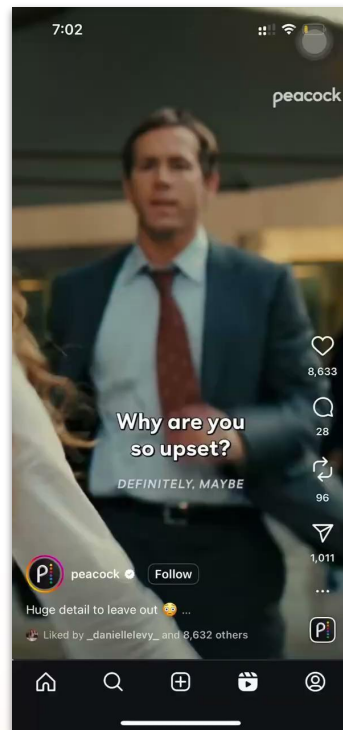


Users are open to AI for **relieving sentimental moments**, but only when movements feel authentic and **true to what really happened**

They want movements that realistically recreate what was likely happening rather than inventing new actions



Competitors already tap into this opportunity, offering ways to **relive past moments** with loved ones



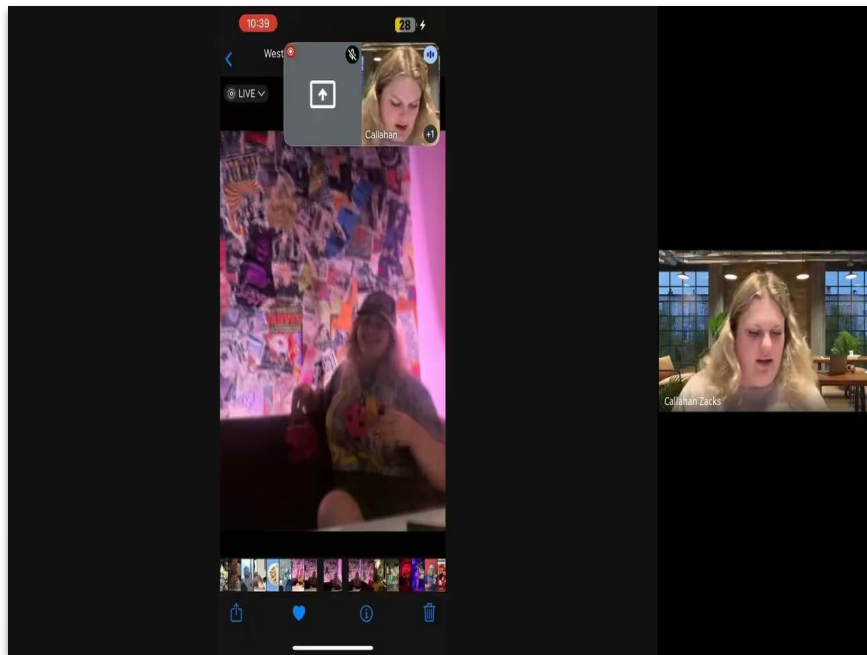
Motive #2: **Making content more engaging & Personable: Adding life into flat photos**

Users see value in making posts more eye-catching and less static- especially when a photo feels too posed or boring.

Common examples to add life and engagement:

- **Adding movement in scenes** – waves, trees, busy streets, concerts, restaurants
- **Adding personality** – laughter, smiles, candid reactions or unique movement
- **Dynamic outfits** – flow of a dress, showcasing angles, textures, and motion beyond static poses

Movement is seen as a way to bring in *personality* or *realness*, without faking it – enhancing what was already there

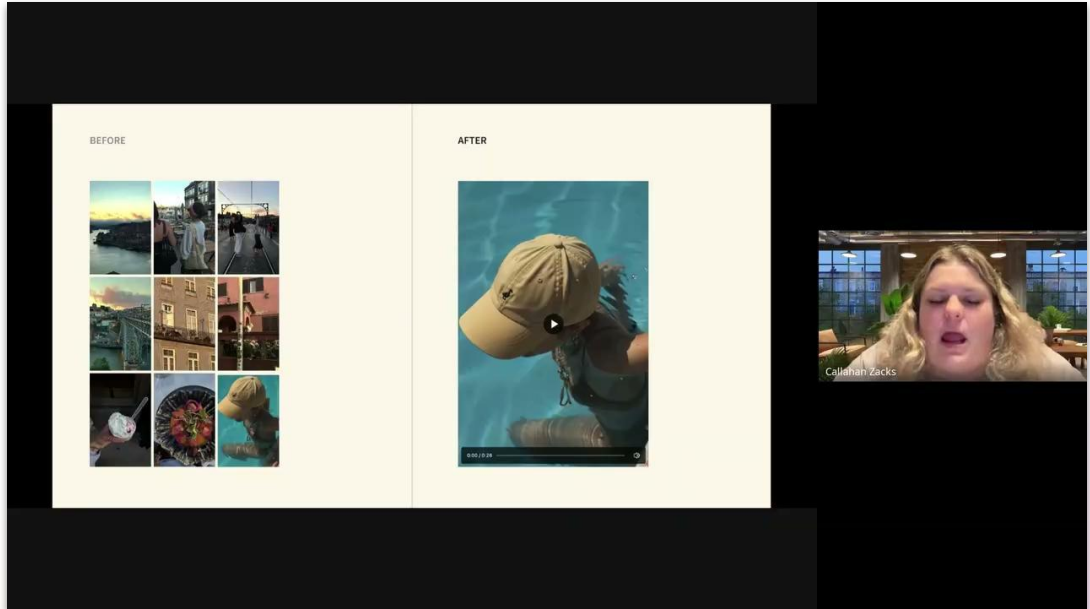


Especially relevant for Alex, the Influencer/Business persona. **Why?**

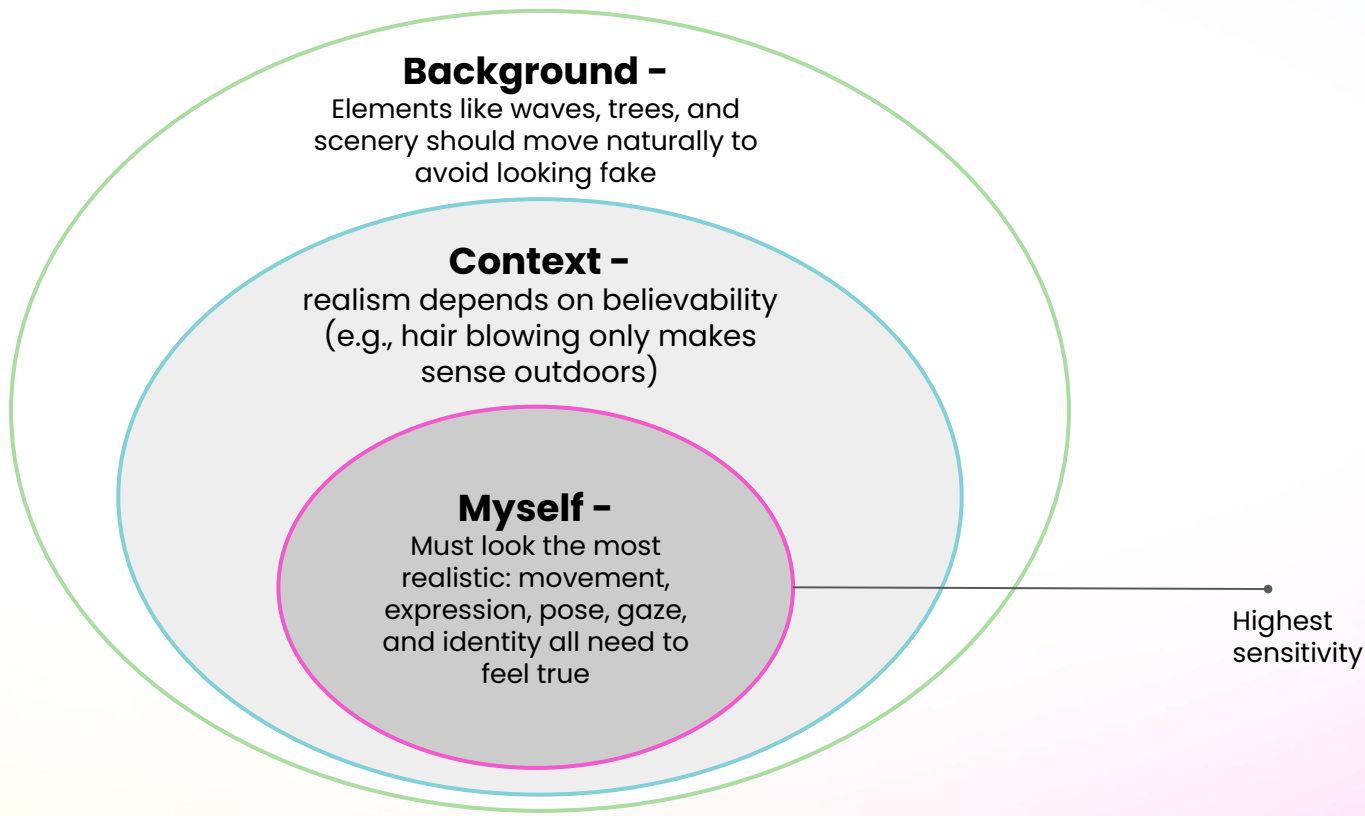
- Enhancing engagement and drawing viewers in while sparking curiosity, by storytelling and interesting visuals
- Creating teaser clips, trip montages, or story-like content
- Saving time by avoiding the effort of editing long videos and stretching content

Concept testing

Users were **excited by the idea of adding motion to still photos, Many admitted they had **never really** thought of this before**



Realism matters most: strongest concerns are with **the main person**, but context and background also play a role

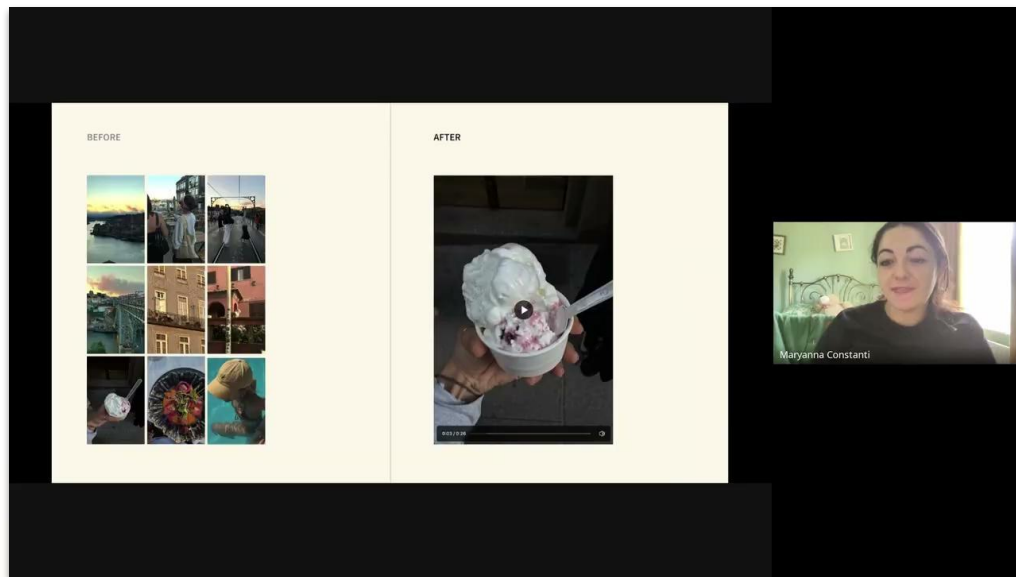


Believable motion is personal & subjective: users interpret **realness differently**, therefore reactions to the concepts **vary** based on individual's perspective

Users want movement to **reflect how they naturally move and express themselves**, so it feels believable and realistic both to them and to others

What does this mean for us?

Users need **more options and variety** in movement — we'll elaborate further in the recommendations



Subtle motion **when feels natural** adds warmth and personality for some, but feels artificial and over-edited to others

BEFORE



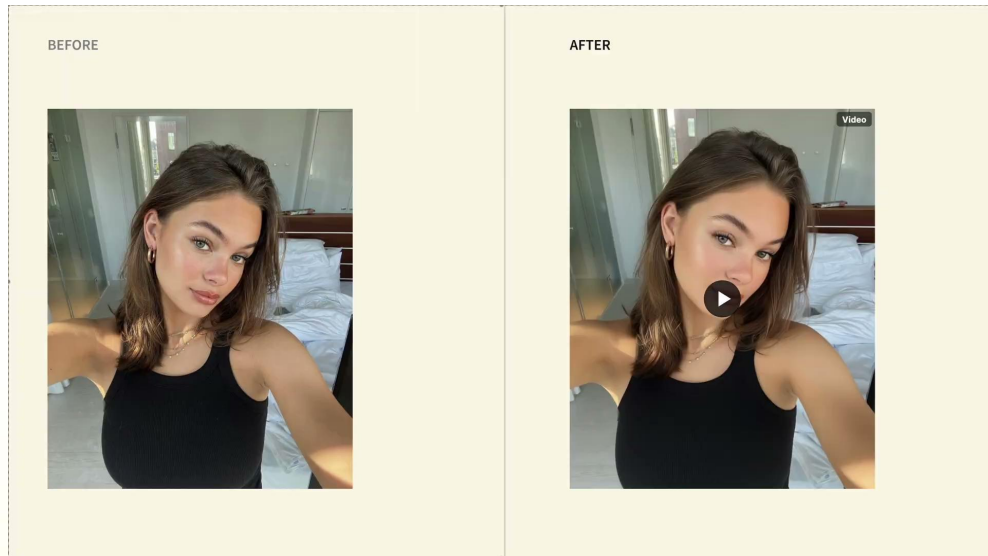
AFTER



Since users interpret “realness” differently reactions varied:

- Some appreciated the added movement and expressions, seeing more **smile** and **personality**
- While others felt it looked **fake** and **overly polished**

When motion adds charm & personality or feels out of context



Reactions varied:

- **Some felt it's a more engaging selfie** – with smiles and nice interaction
- **Some felt motion isn't always worth it** – without real purpose, it adds little value and works better as a selfie
- **Context is a key** – hair blowing indoors felt fake, breaking the realism

Some users loved the added vibe, but others called out fake water

BEFORE



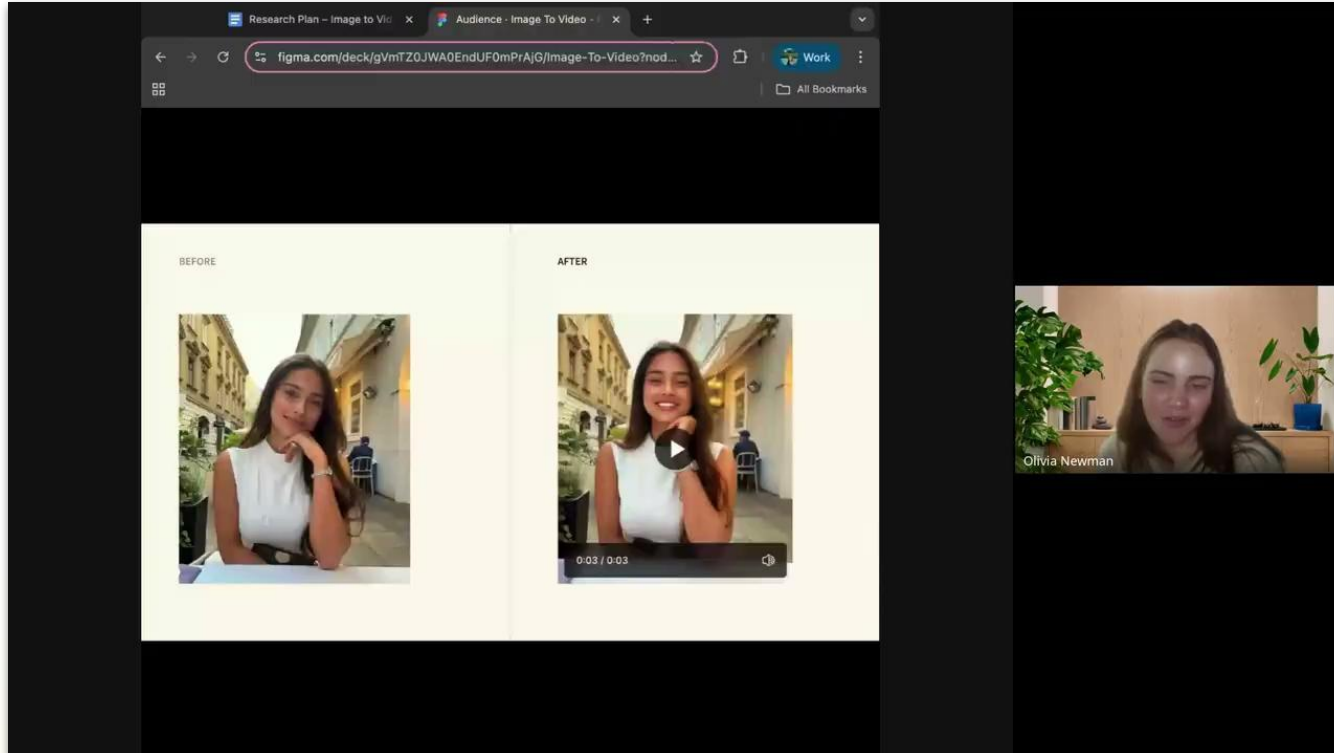
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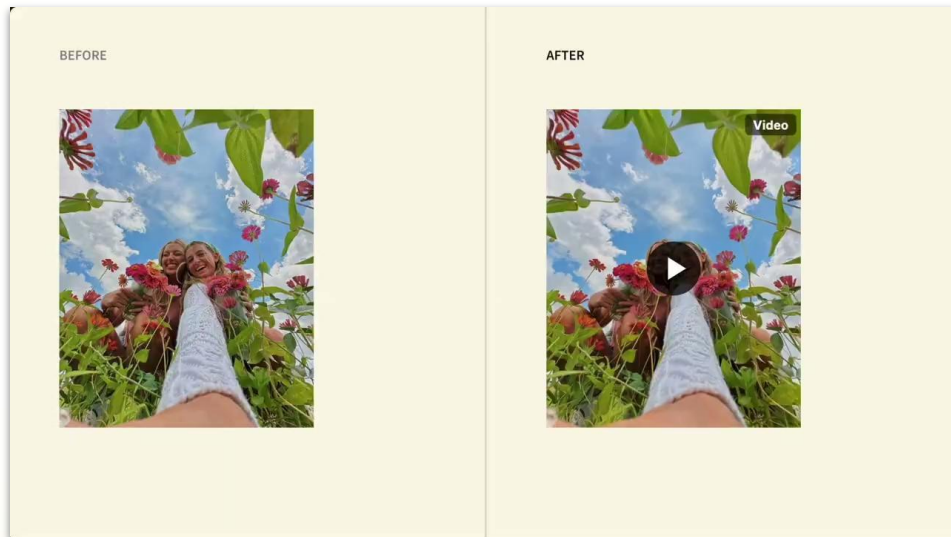
Reactions varied:

- Users loved it for bringing photos **to life** – felt the movement can transform an ordinary still into something engaging
- Others noticed that the water in the pool **doesn't feel realistic**

Since users interpret “realness” differently reactions varied



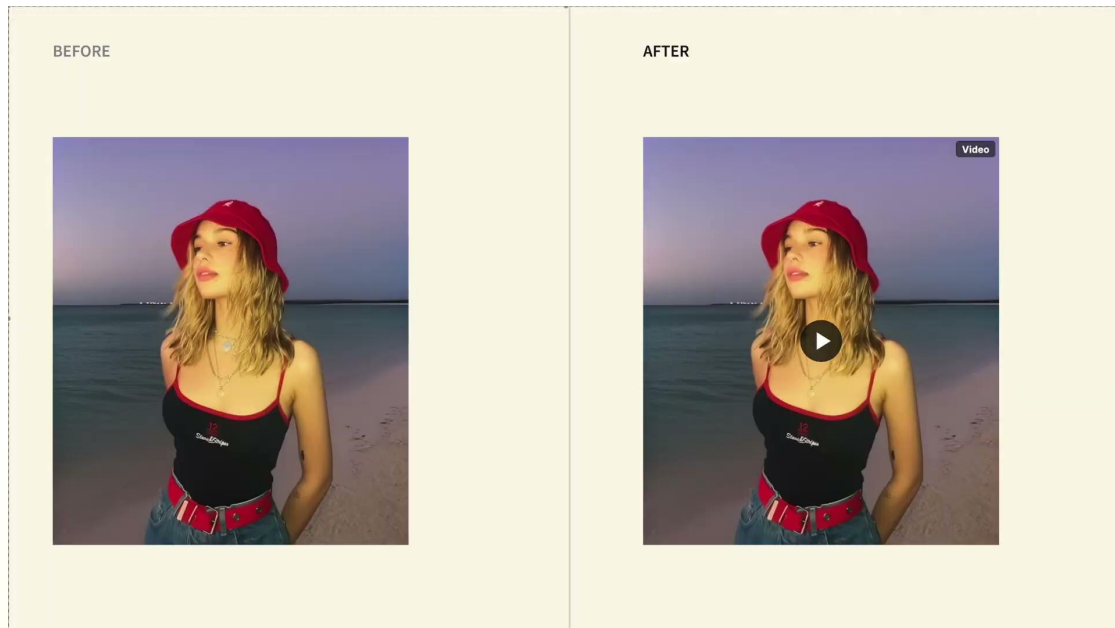
Movement in nature is a major win. Why?



- 1) **Motion matches context**– flowers, leaves, trees, and waves naturally move, so it feels believable
- 2) This adds a **storytelling layer** that conveys the true and full moment

"I like how the leaves and plants are blowing. I think it kind of gives it a whimsy that it didn't have in the photo. Kind of makes it feel like you're there in the moment." **Maria**

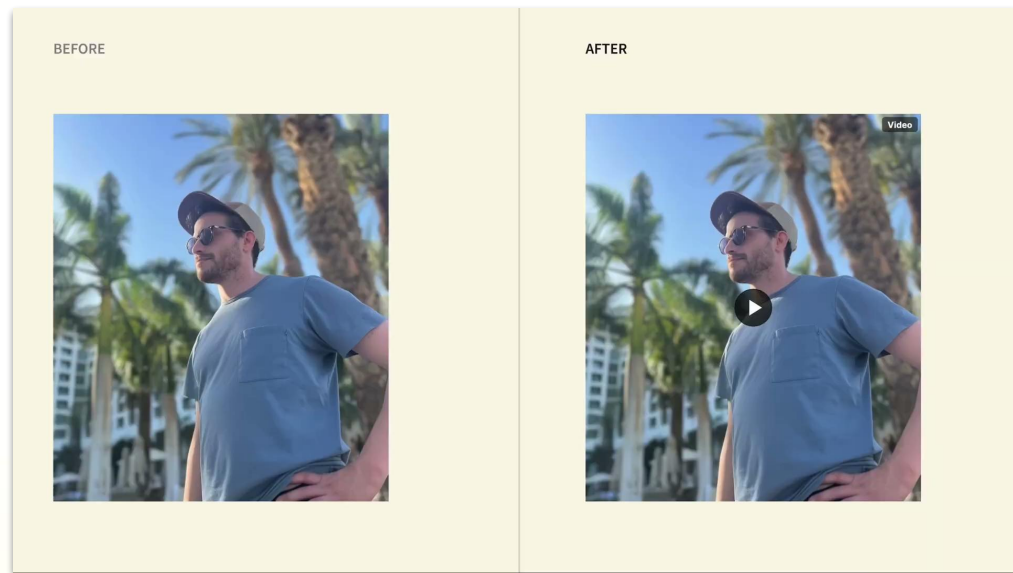
Perfect camera angles and sudden movements felt unrealistic to users



What we can learn from this?

- Camera angles that look **too good for a regular person** to take make it hard to believe the video is real
- **Staged expressions and poses** felt unnatural and uncanny
- **Abrupt background motion** (like waves starting suddenly) breaks realism

When motion doesn't add value



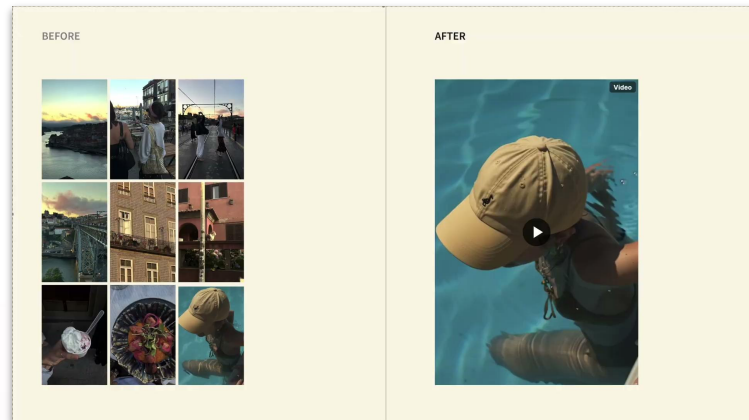
What we can learn from this?

- **No added story or context** – movement felt meaningless when nothing in the scene was actually changing
- **Looked awkward** – the effect came across as weird and unnatural
- **Fake background** – tree movement, in particular, didn't feel realistic

*“When it's just, like, one pose but the camera angle is changing, like, you're not really looking at anything different.” **Kristen***

The 'Story Maker' was the most exciting and useful idea to users. Why?

- **Answers the need to relive missed moments** – users regret not taking a video when photos miss the full experience. They see the Story Maker as allowing them to show the atmosphere, sounds, people, etc.
- **Highly usable & familiar** – fits the type of photos users already take in vacations, special events, and everyday life
- **Curated storytelling** – telling the story of a trip or event, like a travel diary
- **Efficiency** – an easier way to create video content without the time and effort of editing
- **Engagement** – makes content more interactive and immersive, taking the viewer into the moment



Research Plan - Image to Vid x Audience - Image To Video x

figma.com/deck/gVmTZ0JWA0EndUF0mPrAJG/Image-To-Vide... ☆

Work All Bookmarks

BEFORE



AFTER



Olivia Newman

To conclude: What can we learn from users about movement?

- 1) **Nature movement is a favorite** – waves, trees, and flowers make users feel present in the moment
- 2) **Most loved examples show “life happening”** – natural changes in the scene, poses, or interactions that capture the vibe and what was actually happening
- 3) **Movement needs purpose** – especially with people, like changes in smile or laughter convey personality and justify why it’s more than just a photo
- 4) **When done with context, adding motion makes photos feel more realistic** – helps photos feel more alive and in-the-moment, even when powered by AI

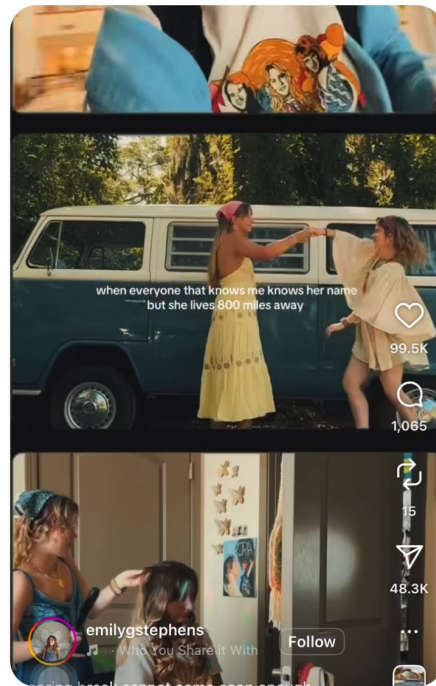
Recommendations

From Story Maker to **Memory Maker**: Reliving any missed moments on iOS and Android

Elevate the Story Maker – Built in several layers:

- **1st layer: Bring stills to life** – turn photos into moving moments
- **2nd layer: Control** – adjust the length and flow of each movement
- **3rd layer: Enhance appearance** – refine expressions or looks
- **4th layer: Add depth** – layer in sound, music, or ambience

*****Leverage Live Photos if available** – upload and extend them with original audio and detail, creating longer, more authentic clips that capture what really happened



Give users **variety** to create movements that match their personality & natural behavior

Opportunities:

- **Provide variations** - offer presets like “smile,” “laugh,” “supermodel look,” or “teasing” to allow users to select their preferred type of movement
- **Let users generate their own movement** - type free-text prompts (Genie-style) to create custom movements
- **Learn from patterns** - analyze which presets of movements are chosen most to refine future options



Combine multiple photos, taken in one moment, into short motion clip to capture missed moments and tell a story

- **Address user pain point** - solve one of the biggest challenges of picking “the best photo” from many (seen in the [pre-editing stages UR](#)) by transforming them into one dynamic moment



How can we **differentiate** ourselves from Live Photos?

Product

- Bring non-Live Photos to life with realistic movement
- Enhance Live Photos and bring added value – extend into longer, more polished clips, add sound and filters, enhance users appearance etc.

Marketing

- Focus on missed moments when users didn't capture a video or Live Photo
- Position Facetune as offering a more polished, enhanced version of Live Photos